

QuickTIMS / CalTrack — Developer Onboarding & Setup Guide

Welcome to the **QuickTIMS / CalTrack** repository! This is a multi-tenant workforce management SaaS platform designed to handle employee timesheets (with GPS + photo verification), scheduling, tasks, leaves, and payroll.

■ Tech Stack

- **Backend:** Python 3.13 / Django 5.2 / Django REST Framework (DRF)
 - **Frontend:** React 19 / Vite / Redux Toolkit (No Tailwind, CSS variables only)
 - **Database:** PostgreSQL 16 (with multi-tenant isolation via [django-tenants](#))
 - **Queue/Real-time:** Redis 7 / Celery / Django Channels (Daphne)
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■ Prerequisites

Ensure you have the following installed on your machine: 1. **Python 3.13+** 2. **Node.js (v18+)** & npm 3. **Docker & Docker Compose**

■ Getting Started

Follow these steps to set up the project locally:

1. Database & Cache Services (Docker)

We use Docker to run PostgreSQL and Redis. 1. Navigate to the root directory. 2. Spin up the containers: `bash docker compose up -d` *Note: This starts PostgreSQL on port 5432 and Redis on port 6379.*

2. Backend Setup (Django)

1. Open a terminal and navigate to the `backend` directory: `bash cd backend` 2. Create and activate a virtual environment: ``bash`

Windows

```
python -m venv .venv .venv\Scripts\activate
```

macOS / Linux

```
python3 -m venv .venv source .venv/bin/activate 3. Install the dependencies: bash pip install -r requirements.txt 4. Copy the environment variables template and configure them: bash cp .env.example .env Note: Open .env and fill in DJANGO_SECRET_KEY, database credentials (if not using defaults), and Google OAuth client keys. 5. Run migrations: bash python manage.py migrate 6. Start the development server: bash python manage.py runserver Alternatively, to run with WebSocket support (Django Channels), start Daphne: bash daphne -b 0.0.0.0 -p 8000 quicktims.asgi:application `
```

3. Queue Services (Celery)

For handling background tasks (reports, invoice generation, email notifications), run the Celery worker and beat in separate terminals (inside the activated virtualenv in the **backend** folder):

- **Celery Worker:**

```
bash celery -A quicktims worker -l info
```

- **Celery Beat** (scheduler):

```
bash celery -A quicktims beat -l info
```

4. Frontend Setup (React + Vite)

1. Open a new terminal and navigate to the **frontend** directory: `bash cd frontend` 2. Install npm packages: `bash npm install` 3. Create a `.env` file for the frontend: `ini VITE_API_BASE_URL=http://localhost:8000/api VITE_GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID=your-google-oauth-client-id.apps.googleusercontent.com` 4. Run the frontend development server: `bash npm run dev` 5. Open your browser and navigate to `http://localhost:5173`.

■ Development Guidelines & Rules

- **No Tailwind CSS:** All styling is done using Vanilla CSS variables and inline styles. Brand colors can be found in `CLAUDE.md`.
- **Database Access:** Always use the Django ORM. Do not write raw queries.
- **Tenant Isolation:** Every queryset must be filtered by the request company/user. Never fetch unscoped data.
- **Named Exports:** In the frontend, always use named exports for pages and components (e.g. `export function Page()`).
- **File Uploads:** All uploads (`ImageField` / `FileField`) are capped at 5MB and validated at the model layer. Ensure you install `python-magic-bin` (on Windows) or `libmagic` (on Linux) in your environment for robust MIME checking.